

Title

Assessment of Traditional Medicinal Plants and Current Threats in Some Selected Kebeles of Diguna Fango Woreda, Wolaita Zone

1. Introduction

- **Background of the Study:**
 - Brief overview of traditional medicine in Ethiopia, particularly in Wolaita Zone.
 - Importance of medicinal plants for rural healthcare.
 - Role of indigenous knowledge in plant use.
- **Problem Statement:**
 - Loss of biodiversity.
 - Declining knowledge transfer.
 - Unsustainable harvesting.
 - Urbanization or land-use changes.
- **Justification:**
 - Why this study is important for the community and conservation efforts.
 - Lack of existing data in the selected kebeles.
 - Potential for preserving local knowledge and biodiversity.

2. Objectives

- **General Objective:**
 - To assess the traditional medicinal plants and the current threats they face in selected kebeles of Diguna Fango Woreda.
- **Specific Objectives:**
 1. To document traditional medicinal plants used by local communities.
 2. To identify and classify the major ailments treated using these plants.
 3. To analyze the methods of preparation and administration.
 4. To assess the current threats to medicinal plants and their knowledge systems.
 5. To suggest potential conservation and awareness strategies.

3. Research Questions

1. What types of traditional medicinal plants are used in the selected kebeles?
2. What ailments are commonly treated with these plants?
3. What are the main threats to these plant species?
4. How is traditional knowledge on medicinal plants transmitted?
5. What conservation measures are in place or needed?

4. Study Area Description

- Geographic location and description of Diguna Fango Woreda.
- Climate, vegetation type, population, and livelihood.
- Highlight the selected kebeles for the study.

5. Methodology

- **Study Design:** Descriptive and ethnobotanical study.
- **Sampling Technique:** Purposive sampling for informants (e.g., elders, traditional healers, herbalists).
- **Sample Size:** Define how many informants and plants you will assess.
- **Data Collection Methods:**
 - Semi-structured interviews
 - Focus group discussions
 - Field observation
 - Plant specimen collection and identification
- **Data Analysis:**
 - Qualitative analysis (content, frequency citation).
 - Quantitative indices (e.g., Informant Consensus Factor, Fidelity Level).

6. Expected Threats and Limitations

- Overharvesting
- Agricultural expansion
- Deforestation
- Cultural shifts
- Limitations: Access, time, informant willingness.

7. Expected Outcomes

- A comprehensive list of medicinal plants used in the area.
- Identified threats and conservation gaps.
- Increased community awareness.
- Baseline data for further ethnobotanical or conservation research.

8. References

Include scholarly references (APA or MLA style) related to:

- Ethnobotany
- Medicinal plants in Ethiopia
- Conservation biology

9. Work Plan and Timeline

Activities	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Month 4
Literature Review ✓				
Data Collection		✓	✓	
Data Analysis			✓	
Report Writing			✓	✓

10. Budget (Optional but Recommended)

Break down of expected costs:

- Transportation
- Materials (e.g., notebooks, plant presses)
- Informant compensation
- Miscellaneous